

phone holds its own, delivering smooth performance with minimal hiccups. However, heavier workloads, such as multitasking with resource-intensive apps, reveal its limitations. Benchmark tests place it behind rivals like the iQOO Z9 and OnePlus Nord CE4 Lite, but it's adequate for basic users.

The phone scored a respectable 409592 points in AnTuTu, and it scored 730 in GeekBench Single Core, and 1922 in GeekBench multicore. In PCMark Work and GPU benchmarks, the score was particularly low compared to competition.

Naturally, gaming enthusiasts might face some disappointment. Titles like Call of Duty: Mobile run acceptably at medium settings but tend to heat the device during extended sessions. On the software front, Samsung's One UI 6.1 on top of Android 14 offers a clean and intuitive experience. Bloatware is minimal as well, especially compared to similarly priced iQOO, realme, and OnePlus offerings. Samsung also promises a whopping 6 years of OS updates, which is excellent for device longevity.

CAMERAS

The Galaxy A16 5G features a triple-camera setup at the back, comprising a 50 MP primary sensor, a 5 MP ultrawide shooter, and a 2 MP macro sensor. On paper, it's a modest setup, and in practice, the results are mixed.

In well-lit conditions, the primary camera captures 12.5 MP binned photos with good detail and natural colours. Dynamic range is respectable, though highlights occasionally appear blown out. The processing is quite aggressive in some shots as well. Portrait photos benefit from accurate edge detection and warm skin tones. The 5 MP ultrawide camera is basic, and allows for decent shots only in well-lit conditions.

Low-light photography is where the A16 5G struggles. Noise creeps in, and images often lack satisfactory dynamic range. Night Mode helps marginally, but it's not a game-changer. The 13 MP front camera is satisfactory for selfies and video calls but struggles with detail in



dim lighting. Video recording is capped at 1080p at 30 fps, which feels limiting when competitors offer 4K options at similar price points.

BATTERY LIFE

Battery life should have been one of the key strengths of the Galaxy A16 5G. However, its 5,000 mAh battery is strictly mediocre. It consistently delivers a day's worth of juice with moderate use, but given the power-efficient chipset and the battery size, we expected a 2-day runtime, which didn't happen, unfortunately.

In our standardised video loop test, the phone lasted 15 hours and 27 minutes, which isn't the best result at this price. Charging isn't remarkable too. The 25 W wired charging feels slow in 2024, with the device taking approximately 1 hour and 31 minutes to reach full capacity. Wireless charging is absent, but it isn't expected at this price point.

VERDICT

The Samsung Galaxy A16 5G is a capable yet unambitious addition to the brand's lineup, catering to users seeking essential functionality rather than standout features. Its understated design, light-weight build, and IP54 rating ensure a practical daily companion, while the

Dimensity 6300 chipset delivers smooth performance for basic tasks. However, the display's 90 Hz refresh rate and moderate brightness levels feel underwhelming in a competitive market.

While its 50 MP camera impresses in daylight, low-light struggles and limited video capabilities reveal its budget nature. Battery performance is adequate but falls short of expectations, given the efficient hardware. At ₹18,999, it faces stiff competition from better-rounded options like the Motorola G85 and OnePlus Nord CE4 Lite.

For brand loyalists or those prioritising Samsung's reliability and software support, the Galaxy A16 5G is worth considering. However, discerning buyers should explore alternatives offering more bang for their buck.

– Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: MediaTek Dimensity 6300 | GPU: Mali G57 MC2 | RAM: 8 GB LPDDR4X | Storage: 128 or 256 GB UFS 2.2 | OS: Android 14, One UI 6.1, 6 years of OS updates | Cameras: 50 MP + 5 MP + 2 MP | Selfie Camera: 13 MP | Display: 6.7" Super AMOLED, 90 Hz, 1080 x 2340 pixels | IP Rating: IP54 | Thickness: 7.9 mm | Weight: 200 g | Battery Capacity: 5,000 mAh | Charging: 25 W

CONTACT

Company: Samsung | Phone: 1-800-5-726-7864 | Email: support.india@samsung.com | Website: <https://www.samsung.com/in/>